

Abhishek A. Desai, MD
abhishek [at] headclone [dot] com

EDUCATION & TRAINING

UC Davis Medical Center 2027-28

Advanced Minimally Invasive and Robotic Surgery Fellowship (incoming)

Rutgers Robert Wood Johnson Medical School 2019-25

General Surgery Residency & Chief Residency

- Robert Wood Johnson University Hospital & Penn-Princeton Medical Center
- John H. Landor, MD, FACS Award for Excellence in Teaching

Boston University 2012-19

Combined Seven-Year Liberal Arts/Medical Education (BA/MD) Program

- AMA Regional Community Service Chairperson
- BA — Medical Science, Linguistics
- Dean's List & Dean's Scholarship
- Sam & Evelyn Margolis Scholarship

WORK & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

WellSpan Chambersburg Hospital 2026-present

General Surgeon

- Elective practice focused on robotic-assisted minimally-invasive surgery
- ER call for emergency general surgery

University of Pennsylvania 2021-22

Clinical Research Fellow, Division of Plastic Surgery

- Developed ML methods to augment surgical risk modeling with unstructured data
- Published on optimal surgical technique for ventral hernia repair
- Studied applications of 3-D computer vision for peri-operative care

Massachusetts General Hospital 2016-17

Research Specialist, Eskandar Lab

- Overhauled design of the *OpBox*, an open-source operant conditioning & experimental environment for small rodents
- Analyzed rapid-sample EEG to study neural activity during decision making
- Developed diagnostic software to debug EEG signal anomalies

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE**SAGES Robotics Committee**

2025-present

Member

- Lead, Autonomous Surgery Working Group, 2026-present

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- [Anterior Component Separation Technique and Its Modifications for Ventral Hernia Repair](#) *Newer Concepts and Procedures in Hernia Surgery - An Atlas*. 2022.
- [Mesh exposure after ventral hernia repair with onlay biosynthetic mesh: a retrospective review of associated risk factors and management strategies](#) *Hernia*. 2024.
- [Leveraging Natural Language Processing and Artificial Intelligence to Label Unstructured Data for Risk Prediction](#) *British Journal of Surgery*. 2023.
- [Optimal computed tomography-based biomarkers for prediction of incisional hernia formation](#) *Hernia*. 2024.
- [Preoperative Computed Tomography Morphological Features Indicative of Incisional Hernia Formation After Abdominal Surgery](#) *Annals of Surgery*. 2022.
- [Shifting the Goalpost in Ventral Hernia Care: 5-year Outcomes after Ventral Hernia Repair with Poly-4-hydroxybutyrate Mesh](#) *Hernia*. 2022.

ALL PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS**Book Chapters**

1. Butler CE, Fischer JP, Desai AA. Anterior Component Separation Technique and Its Modifications for Ventral Hernia Repair. In: Baig SJ, Bhandarkar D, Priya P, eds. *Newer Concepts and Procedures in Hernia Surgery - An Atlas*. Springer Nature; 2022:35-44. doi:10.1007/978-981-19-5248-7_4

Journal Articles

1. Davis HD, Mazzaferro D, Habarth-Morales TE, Messa CA, Talwar AA, Desai AA, et al. A Large Prospective Volumetric and Patient-Reported Outcome Analysis of Hyaluronic Acid Facial Fillers. *Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery*. 2025;156(4):550-559. doi:10.1097/PRS.00000000000012135
2. Amro C, Ryan I, Lemdani MS, Bascone CM, McAuliffe PB, Desai AA, et al. Mesh exposure after ventral hernia repair with onlay biosynthetic mesh: a retrospective review of associated risk factors and management strategies. *Hernia*. 2024;28(6):2165-2176. doi:10.1007/s10029-024-03108-7
3. Talwar AA, Desai AA, McAuliffe PB, et al. Optimal computed tomography-based biomarkers for prediction of incisional hernia formation. *Hernia*. 2024;28(1):17-24. doi:10.1007/s10029-023-02835-7
4. McAuliffe PB, Winter EE, Talwar AA, Desai AA, Broach RB, Fischer JP. Pressure Ulcer Trends in the United States: A Cross-Sectional Assessment from 2008-2019. *The American Surgeon*. 2023;89(12):5609-5618. doi:10.1177/00031348231158691
5. Talwar AA, Desai AA, McAuliffe PB, Broach RB, Percec I. Plastic Surgery Resident Training and Interest in Reconstruction for Female Genital Mutilation/Cutting. *Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery*. 2023;151(5):888e-890e. doi:10.1097/PRS.00000000000010057
6. McAuliffe PB, Muss TEL, Desai AA, Talwar AA, Broach RB, Fischer JP. Complications of Aesthetic Surgical Tourism Treated in the USA: A Systematic Review. *Aesthetic Plastic Surgery*. 2023;47(1):455-464. doi:10.1007/s00266-022-03041-z

7. Talwar AA, Perry NJ, McAuliffe PB, Desai AA, Thrippleton S, Broach RB, Fischer JP. Shifting the Goalpost in Ventral Hernia Care: 5-year Outcomes after Ventral Hernia Repair with Poly-4-hydroxybutyrate Mesh. *Hernia*. 2022;26(6):1635-1643. doi:10.1007/s10029-022-02674-y
8. Malphrus EL, Desai A, Weiss ES, Couto JA, Broach R, Butler PD. Understanding public perception of bra size. *Journal of Plastic, Reconstructive & Aesthetic Surgery*. 2022;75(11):4197-4201. doi:10.1016/j.bjps.2022.08.038
9. McAuliffe PB, Desai AA, Talwar AA, et al. Preoperative Computed Tomography Morphological Features Indicative of Incisional Hernia Formation After Abdominal Surgery. *Annals of Surgery*. 2022;276(4):616-625. doi:10.1097/SLA.0000000000005583
10. Talwar AA, Shulkin JM, Hitchner M, McAuliffe PB, Desai AA, Broach RB, Percec I. Use of Cosmetic Facial Injectables After Facial Aesthetic Surgery. *Aesthetic Surgery Journal*. 2022;42(10):1194-1204. doi:10.1093/asj/sjac171
11. Talwar AA, Perry NJ, Barrero C, et al. Patient-reported and clinical outcomes of skin graft-based digital Mohs reconstructions. *Orthoplastic Surgery*. 2022;9:56-60. doi:10.1016/j.orthop.2022.06.004
12. Elfanagely O, Desai A, Arias F, Azzolini A, Agag RL, Sinkin JC. Evaluation of the credibility and credentials of social media reconstructive plastic surgery influencers on Twitter. *Journal of Plastic, Reconstructive & Aesthetic Surgery*. 2022;75(7):2387-2440. doi:10.1016/j.bjps.2022.04.068

Published Abstracts

1. Talwar A, Perry NJ, Desai A, et al. Minimizing the Mesh Footprint: 5-year Follow Up After Hernia Repair Using Poly-4-hydroxybutyrate Mesh. *Journal of the American College of Surgeons*. 2023;236(5):S41. doi:10.1097/01.XCS.0000932628.35596.3c
2. Amro C, Desai A, Dattatri P, et al. Leveraging Natural Language Processing And Artificial Intelligence To Label Unstructured Data For Risk Prediction. *British Journal of Surgery*. 2023;110(Supplement 2):znad080.026. doi:10.1093/bjs/znad080.026
3. McAuliffe PB, Kozak G, Bascone C, et al. Botulinum Toxin Use for Abdominal Wall Reconstruction. *Journal of the American College of Surgeons*. 2022;235(5):S201. doi:10.1097/01.XCS.0000894548.92795.e8
4. Desai AA, Talwar AA, McAuliffe PB, et al. Artificially Intelligent Facial Feature Quantification After Facial Filler Injection. *Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery - Global Open*. 2022. doi:10.1097/01.GOX.0000828688.22660.1a

Grand Rounds

1. *Show Me the Money: How I Learned the Bitter Lesson and You Will Too*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD. Department of Surgery Grand Rounds, Rutgers Robert Wood Johnson Medical School, 2025

Podium Presentations

1. *Characterizing morbidity and mortality after aesthetic abdominal surgery: a US nationwide analysis*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Jesse Y. Hsu, PhD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, John P. Fischer, MD, MPH. 32nd Meeting of the European Association of Plastic Surgeons, 2022
2. *Artificially Intelligent Facial Feature Quantification after Facial Filler Injection*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Adrienne N. Christopher, MD, Viren Patel, MD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, Ivona Percec, MD. The Aesthetic Society Meeting, 2022
3. *Characterizing morbidity and mortality after aesthetic abdominal surgery: a US nationwide analysis*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Jesse Y. Hsu, PhD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, John P. Fischer, MD, MPH. Plastic Surgery Research Council Meeting, 2022
4. *Breast Flap Neurotization Following Autologous Breast Reconstruction: A Prospective Trial*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Michael G. Tecce, DO, Adrienne Christopher, MD, Jessica Cuning, MD, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Arturo J. Rios-Diaz, MD, Shelby L. Nathan, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD. Plastic Surgery Research Council Meeting, 2022
5. *Artificially Intelligent Facial Feature Quantification after Facial Filler Injection*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Adrienne N. Christopher, MD, Viren Patel, MD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, Ivona Percec, MD. 68th Meeting of the Robert H Ivy Society of Plastic Surgeons, 2022

6. *Characterizing morbidity and mortality after aesthetic abdominal surgery: a US nationwide analysis*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Jesse Y. Hsu, PhD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, John P. Fischer, MD, MPH. 68th Meeting of the Robert H Ivy Society of Plastic Surgeons, 2022
7. *Breast Flap Neurotization Following Autologous Breast Reconstruction: A Prospective Trial*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Michael G. Tecce, DO, Adrienne Christopher, MD, Jessica Cuning, MD, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Arturo J. Rios-Diaz, MD, Shelby L. Nathan, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD. 68th Meeting of the Robert H Ivy Society of Plastic Surgeons, 2022
8. *What's in a cup? Understanding Public Perception of Breast Size*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Elizabeth L. Malphrus, MD, Eric S Weiss, MD, Javier A Couto, MD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Paris D. Butler, MD. 68th Meeting of the Robert H Ivy Society of Plastic Surgeons, 2022

Poster Presentations

1. *Breast Flap Neurotization Following Autologous Breast Reconstruction: A Prospective Trial*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Michael G. Tecce, DO, Adrienne Christopher, MD, Jessica Cuning, MD, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Arturo J. Rios-Diaz, MD, Shelby L. Nathan, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD. American Association of Plastic Surgeons Centennial Meeting, 2022
2. *Artificially Intelligent Facial Feature Quantification after Facial Filler Injection*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Ankoor A. Talwar, MBA, Phoebe B. McAuliffe, BS, Martin P. Morris, MBE, Adrienne N. Christopher, MD, Viren Patel, MD, Robyn B. Broach, PhD, Joseph M. Serletti, MD, Ivona Percec, MD. American Association of Plastic Surgeons Centennial Meeting, 2022
3. *Revisional Bariatric Surgery for Failure to Lose Weight/Weight Regain and Refractory Complications at a Single MBSAQIP Accredited Center over Three Years.*
Abhishek A. Desai, MD, Jacob Nudel, MD, Hassan Beesley, BS, Donald Hess, MD. Annual Meeting of the American Society for Metabolic and Bariatric Surgery, 2019